



Lesson 1: What Is Coding, Anyway?

Hi, Future Coder! 🙌

Today you are starting a brand new adventure. You are going to learn how to talk to computers in their own special language. This is called **coding**.



Think Like a Coder: What Is Code?

Code is a list of instructions — step by step — that tells a computer exactly what to do.

Here's the secret: **computers have NO imagination.** They cannot guess what you mean. They can only do exactly, precisely, what you tell them, one step at a time.

Think about it like a recipe. If a recipe says "add sugar," but doesn't say how much, the cake could turn out very strange! Code has to be that exact, every single time.



Robot Tip

Imagine you have a robot friend. If you tell your robot "make my bed," it might just stare at you — because it doesn't know what "make my bed" means unless you explain EVERY step: 1. Pull up the sheet. 2. Straighten the blanket. 3. Fluff the pillow. 4. Put the pillow at the top.

That's what coding feels like — being super clear so your robot friend (the computer) can follow along perfectly.



Where Is Code Hiding?

Code is all around you, even when you can't see it! Can you spot code in: - Your favorite video game - A traffic light changing colors - A microwave that beeps when your food is ready - A phone that lights up when you get a message

All of these follow instructions that a person wrote — just like you're about to do!



Game Challenge: Human Robot

You are going to play a fun game with a partner: - One of you is the **Coder**. - One of you is the **Robot**. - The Coder gives ONE instruction at a time (like "take 2 steps forward" or "turn left"). - The Robot follows EXACTLY

what is said — nothing more, nothing less!

Try to get your Robot to a target spot using only 5 instructions or fewer. Then switch roles!

Bonus Challenge

Can you write instructions for a totally silly task, like "how to do the best victory dance ever"? Use at least 6 exact steps. Have someone follow your instructions exactly — no cheating, no guessing!

Victory Moment

You just did your very first "unplugged" coding — writing instructions without even touching a computer! That means you already think like a real coder. Next lesson, you'll get to open Scratch and meet your very first sprite (that's the character you'll bring to life with code).

Great job today, coder. See you in Lesson 2! 